Downloading the Course Files and Preparing Power BI Desktop

Estimated setup time: 5–10 minutes

What You'll Need

- ☐ Power BI Desktop installed (Windows only)
- ☐ The course data files, provided with this course
- ☐ About 50MB of free disk space

The 60-Second Explanation

Sales Report Raw is a partly built Power BI file. Its queries currently point at a folder on the course author's computer, not yours. This guide has you download the real data files, put them in a folder of your choosing, and repoint one setting, called a **parameter**, so the file reads from your machine instead. Once that's done, every table loads correctly and you're ready for the next guide, **Connecting Claude to Power BI**.

1 Download the Course Files

Download the **Data Files** folder provided with this course. It contains:

- DimCustomer, DimGeography, DimProduct, DimProductCategory, DimProductSubcategory, FactInternetSales
- **Sales Report Raw** — the starter Power BI file
- **UserSecurity** — an Excel workbook used later in the course

> **TIP**
> Ignore UserSecurity for now. It's used later, in the Chapter 9 bonus on dynamic row-level security, not during setup.

2 Create Your Lab Folder

- Choose any location on your computer, for example Documents
- Create one folder and name it Data Files
- Move every downloaded file into that single folder

> **WATCH OUT**
> Keep every file in the same folder. Power BI reads all the data files from one folder location, if a file is moved out, that table will fail to load.

3 Open the Starter File

- Double-click Sales Report Raw to open it in Power BI Desktop

- A yellow warning bar about a missing folder is expected here, continue to Step 4

4 Update the Folder Path Parameter

- On the Home ribbon, click Transform Data, then Manage Parameters
- Select FolderPath in the list on the left
- Replace Current Value with the full path to your own Data Files folder
- Click OK

Figure 1 — Manage Parameters, with FolderPath selected and Current Value ready to edit

5 Refresh and Verify

- On the Home ribbon, click Refresh
- Wait for the queries to finish loading, this can take a minute
- In the Fields pane, confirm six tables appear: DimCustomer, DimGeography, DimProduct, DimProductCategory, DimProductSubcategory, FactInternetSales

> **WATCH OUT**
> A query error here almost always means a typo in the folder path, or a missing trailing backslash. Recheck Step 4.

6 Save

- Press Ctrl+S
- Keep Sales Report Raw open, you'll connect Claude to this same file in the next guide

🏁 Quick Recap

- Download the Data Files folder and starter file
- Put everything in one folder
- Open Sales Report Raw, update FolderPath to your folder
- Refresh, confirm six tables load
- Save, and keep the file open

Next: continue to **Connecting Claude to Power BI**.